Latest Answers to the Scribe API

1) Preview text running off the card

The simplest explanation is:

- **At least one line is exceeding the max width** (**52 characters including indentation**), and/or
- The message is being sent **without the expected line breaks**, so it's effectively treated as one long line and will overflow.

To fix this, you'll want to implement a small formatter function using the **Message Formatter Technical Spec** I sent over (line wrapping + max lines + indentation rules). Then:

1. Run the **formatted output** through `/api/v1/preview`
2. Once the preview looks good, send that same formatted message into `/api/add-campaign-v2`

That should eliminate the overflow behavior. If you want, I can provide code snippets in your preferred language — but I think the spec should be enough to vibe-code it quickly.

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2) "Dear firstname…" showing instead of the contact name

This happens because of **call order** in the integration:

- The **campaign is being created first**, and then
- the **contact is being added afterward**

So at the time the campaign preview/message is generated, the contact merge values (like first name) aren't available yet, and the placeholder renders literally.

You can see the intended final output once the contact is associated correctly. For example, from **campaign ID 3552**, the final printed message in our system is:

Dear Danielle,

Thanks for letting us help with your roof after the storm. I know how stressful this process can be, and I'm glad we could make it a little easier.
If you know anyone else going through the same thing, I'd be grateful if you mentioned us.

Sincerely,
mitch fields
My Roof Co
9165551313

How to fix this for previews:
If you want the preview to render with the contact's first name (and other merge fields), you'll need to change the order of operations slightly:

1. First, create the campaign shell using `/api/create-campaign-id-v2`
2. Add the contact(s) to the campaign
3. Then update the campaign content using `/api/edit-campaign-v2` (with the same payload structure you would normally send to `/api/add-campaign-v2`)

This ensures the contact data is already associated with the campaign at the time the message is generated, allowing placeholders like `[[first_name]]` to resolve correctly in the preview.

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As promised, here is the **Message Formatter Technical Spec** that explains how our system formats message text to simulate handwritten notes, including line limits, wrapping behavior, and natural-looking indentation.

You can use this specification to **build your own message-processing function on your side** so that your output matches what our system expects. Once formatted, you can send the result to the `/api/v1/preview` endpoint to confirm the rendering looks correct before submitting the message to a live campaign.

Message Formatter Logic with Random Indentation

Objective:
Format text to simulate handwritten notes with strict layout constraints while creating natural-looking indentation.

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1) Constraints & Constants

- **Max Lines:**
  - 13 lines if `text_type = "Short Text"`
  - 19 lines if `text_type = "Long Text"`
- **Max Width:** 52 characters per line (including indentation)
- **Indentation:** 0–5 spaces, applied **randomly to middle lines only**

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2) Processing Flow

Input Cleaning

- Trim whitespace from the start and end of the input
- Throw an error if the message is empty

Line Breaking Strategy

Scenario A — User has manually added newlines

- Respect existing manual line breaks
- If any single line exceeds 52 characters, that line is wrapped at word boundaries

Scenario B — No manual newlines

- Normalize all whitespace to single spaces
- Wrap text at word boundaries
- **Safety Margin:** Lines are wrapped at **MAX_CHARS − 3 (49 characters)** to reserve space for potential indentation

Validation

- If the formatted result exceeds the allowed number of lines:
    - Overflowing words are extracted
    - The system throws:
      "Your message is too long…"

Indentation Logic (The "Handwritten" Look)

- **First Line:** Never indented
- **Last Line:** Never indented
- **Middle Lines:** Randomly indented **1–3 spaces**

Algorithm:

- Calculate **Target Total Indent** = (Number of Middle Lines) × 2
- Randomly distribute this total across middle lines
    - Each line receives **at least 1 space and at most 3 spaces**
- **Constraint Check:**
    - If adding indentation would cause a line to exceed 52 characters, indentation is skipped for that line

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3) Output

- All formatted lines are returned joined with newline characters (`\n`)

How to Use This in Your Integration

1. Implement this logic in your application to pre-format the message text.
2. Send the formatted message to `/api/v1/preview` to verify how it will render.
3. Once the preview looks correct, submit the same formatted message to the campaign endpoint (e.g., `/api/add-campaign-v2`).

This approach will let you catch layout issues (overflow, wrapping, indentation) early and ensure the final printed output matches expectations.

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1. ZIP File Image Order

Question:
Please confirm: In a two-image ZIP, is `1.png` the outside/main design and `2.png` the inside (where the message is printed)?

Answer:
Yes, that's correct.

When you upload a ZIP file containing multiple images, our system processes them in alphanumeric order based on the file names. In a two-image ZIP:

- **1.png** is treated as the outside / main design
- **2.png** is treated as the inside (where the message is printed)

As long as the files are named accordingly, the designs will be applied in the expected order.

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2. Image Dimensions

Question:
The documentation specifies **1375 × 2000 pixels**. Please confirm:

- Is this the exact required dimension, or is there tolerance?
- Are images rejected if they don't match exactly?
- Does your system resize/crop images, or must they be exact?

Answer:
Yes — **1375 × 2000 pixels is the exact required dimension**, and images must match this size.

At this time:

- There is **no tolerance** for alternate dimensions
- Images that do not meet this size may fail processing
- Our system **does not resize or crop** uploaded designs automatically — files must be prepared at the correct dimensions before upload

Once uploaded successfully, our system processes the images into a campaign, and the API will return hosted image URLs that you can use to display previews on your front end.

To make design setup easier, you can create, customize, and export directly from our Canva template here:
https://www.canva.com/design/DAFxz_x-wrM/OFzQr-3l_qZimrt7SL5eWA/view?utm_content=DAFxz_x-wrM&utm_campaign=designshare&utm_medium=link&utm_source=publishsharelink&mode=preview

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3. Image Format

Question:

- Are both PNG and JPG/JPEG accepted?
- Is there a preferred format?
- Is there a maximum file size per image or for the ZIP?

Answer:
Yes — both **PNG** and **JPG/JPEG** image formats are accepted when included inside a ZIP file.

At this time:

- There is **no required or preferred format** between PNG and JPG/JPEG
- The ZIP file has a **maximum size limit of 20 MB**

As long as the images meet the required dimensions and the ZIP file remains under the size limit, the upload will process as expected.

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4. Blank / White Inside Option

Question:
If we want a plain white inside (no design), must we include a white 1375×2000 PNG file, or can we:

- Omit the inside image from the ZIP entirely?
- Upload a single-image ZIP and have the inside default to white?

Answer:
We recommend including a plain white inside image to ensure the outside and inside designs are mapped to the correct positions.

That said, it **should still work** if you upload a ZIP file with only the outside design. In that case:

- The outside will be applied as expected
- The inside will default to **blank/white**

For maximum consistency and to avoid any mapping issues, including a white inside image is the preferred approach.

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5. Return Address JSON Format

Question:
For the `/api/add-campaign-v2` endpoint, we're sending `return_address` as a JSON string in the multipart form:

{"firstName":"Company Name","lastName":"","street":"123 Main St","city":"Austin","state":"TX","zip":"78701"}

For company return addresses, we put the company name in `firstName` and leave `lastName` empty. Is this correct, or is there a separate `companyName` field?
What if they want the return address to be:
Company Name
Attn: FirstName LastName
Address
Address2
City, ST Zip

Is that possible?

Answer:
Yes — if you are using a company name instead of an individual's name, you should map the company name to `firstName` and leave `lastName` blank. At this time, we do **not** have a separate `companyName` field.

When we receive letter orders, the return address is processed through our handwritten letter software, which uses a fixed template. Because of this, we do **not** support custom formatting such as:

- Company Name on one line with "Attn: FirstName LastName" on a second line
- Additional address formatting beyond the standard layout

The return/mailing address format is always:

First Name Last Name
Street Address
City, State, ZIP

So while a company name can be used in place of a person's name, the structure of the return address itself cannot be customized beyond that template.

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6. Address Line 2 Placeholder

Question:
Does the `{ADDRESS_2}` placeholder work in message text? If a contact has no address2, is it replaced with an empty string or does it appear literally as `{ADDRESS_2}`?
Do you have a specific way to handle Address Line 2, including on the envelope? Does the line get eliminated if it is blank?

Answer:
At this time, we **do not support an Address Line 2 field** in our system.

Because of that:

- There is **no `{ADDRESS_2}` placeholder** available for message content
- Any Address Line 2 data cannot be passed, printed, or displayed on the envelope or inside the message
- If you need to include additional address details, they would need to be merged into the primary street address field before submission

For this reason, removing `{ADDRESS_2}` from your message templates is the correct approach.

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7. Text Type Auto-Detection

Question:
If we send a message that's borderline (around 110 words), does Scribe validate our `text_type` selection, or does it trust what we send? What happens if we send "Short Text" but the message exceeds the limit?

Answer:
At this time, there is **no backend validation** on the message length or `text_type` passed into these endpoints. The API will accept whatever message content is submitted.

Because of that, we recommend using the `/api/v1/preview` endpoint to validate how your message will render before sending it to `/api/add-campaign-v2`. This allows you to confirm that what you are submitting will be processed and formatted as expected.

If helpful, I can also provide a **message formatter technical specification** in a separate email that outlines the formatting rules and constraints in more detail.

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8. Staging Environment

Question:

- Is https://staging.scribenurture.com available for testing?
- Does it use the same API token as production, or do we need a separate staging token?
- Are cards actually printed/mailed from staging, or is it simulation only?

Answer:
Yes — https://staging.scribenurture.com is our dedicated **testing environment** and is free to use for development and QA.

Please note:

- **Staging and Production use separate databases**, so account data is isolated between environments
- You will need a **separate account and API token** for staging
- **No cards are printed or mailed** from the staging environment — it is for **testing and simulation only**

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9. Rate Limits

Question:
Are there any rate limits we should be aware of for:

- API calls per minute/hour?
- Contacts per campaign?
- Campaigns per day?

Answer:
The primary hard limit to be aware of is our **API throttle of 60 requests per minute**.

At this time, there are no additional enforced limits on contacts per campaign or campaigns per day at the API level, but the request-rate limit should be accounted for in your integration design.

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10. Campaign Status & Webhooks

Question:
Is there a webhook option to receive status updates (printed, shipped, delivered), or must we poll `/api/v1/campaign-status`? If polling, what's the recommended frequency?

Answer:
At this time, we **do not offer webhook support** for campaign status updates.

Our recommendation is to **poll the `/api/v1/campaign-status` endpoint on demand**, such as when a user clicks a "Check Status" button in your application. This approach avoids unnecessary API traffic while still giving users real-time visibility into their campaign progress.

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11. Error Handling & Invalid Addresses

Question:
When an API call fails, what's the response format?

- Is there an error code we can use for programmatic handling?
- What's the response when a contact has an invalid/undeliverable address?

Answer:
Our API error codes and response formats are documented here:

- **Staging:** https://staging.scribenurture.com/api/documentation
- **Production:** https://scribenurture.com/api/documentation

Regarding address validation:

- We accept any contact that includes a non-empty **street address, city, state, and ZIP**
- We do **not** currently return errors for invalid or undeliverable addresses
- If an address meets the required fields, it will be accepted by the API

For best results, we strongly recommend validating addresses **before** submission using tools such as **Smarty** or the **Google Address Validation API**.

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12. Contact Limits

Question:
Is there a maximum number of contacts per campaign or per `/api/add-contacts-bulk` request?

Answer:
We recommend using the `/api/v1/add-contacts-bulk` endpoint, which is designed to **queue any number of contacts** with no hard limit.

We've tested this successfully with **10,000 contacts** in a single submission, and it performed as expected — ideal for high-volume campaigns.

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13. Multi-Image ZIP Processing

Question:
When uploading a ZIP with two images:

- Which image becomes the outside?
- Which becomes the inside?
- Does file order or filename determine assignment?

Answer:
This is covered by **Question #1** above — assignment is based on **alphanumeric filename order** (e.g., `1.png` = outside, `2.png` = inside).

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14. Placeholder Resolution / Preview Formatting

Question:
The previews in staging appear to run off the page. Do we need to send line breaks? What are the rules? Do you have sample files?

Answer:
I'll follow up with a **separate email** that includes a **"Message Formatter Technical Spec."** That document will outline the exact formatting rules, line-break handling, and constraints used by our rendering system, along with example content you can reference.